

.com/handbook/company/culture/all-remote/informal-communication/coffee-chats"
click id2box5 "https://about.gitlab.com/community/hackathon/"

end

subgraph id3["Learn about GitLab"]

id3box1("Tutorials")

id3box2("GitLab Handbook")

click id3box1 "https://docs.gitlab.com/ee/tutorials/"

click id3box2 "https://handbook.gitlab.com/handbook/"

end

%% Root level mappings

start --> id1

start --> id2

start --> id3

start --> id4

%% Contribution Process

%% Mappings

%% Mapping Subgraph contribute to code with Contribution Process

id4box1 --> id5box1

%% 3. Setting up local dev

id5sg1 --> id7

%% 4. Issue Workflow

id5sg2 --> id8

%% 5. MR WorkFlow

id5sg3 --> id9

%% 6. Triage Process

</div>

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/contributor-success/templates/email-templates.html.md

Direct email messaging

Below are email templates that can be used for communicating with community members. Whenever possible, it is strongly encouraged that each email message be customized for each individual & circumstance.

Outreach after the first merged MR

Directly via email

text

Hello NAME,

I'm reaching out to both thank and congratulate you on your first Merge Request (MR) to help improve GitLab. We appreciate everyone's effort to contribute to GitLab, especially when it's an individual initiative and we are blessed to have such a wonderful community.

I wanted to offer you a small token of our appreciation as you're getting started with your code contributions to GitLab. Please go to [URL] to submit your order for the latest GitLab mug with a special hashtag to celebrate your first merged MR. When you receive the merchandise, it would be great if you can make a post on twitter with your photo of the mug plus '@gitlab' & 'myfirstMRmerged' in the tweet.

Thanks again for your first MR to GitLab and welcome to the GitLab community!

Sincerely,
YOURNAME

As a comment on their merged MR

text

Hi there, and congratulations on having your first MR merged!

I want to offer you a small token of our appreciation as you're getting started with your code contributions to GitLab. Please fill out this form, and I will be reaching out with more information on how to receive your special my1stMRmerged coffee mug.

Outreach to inactive contributors

text

Hello NAME,

I'm reaching out to you as we have not seen a merged MR from you since DATE. The GitLab community would not be the same if it weren't for contributors like you. If you haven't done so lately, you can look for issues that are "Seeking community contributions" as we would welcome your help on these.

Please let me know if you have any questions and I look forward to your continued involvement in the GitLab community.

Sincerely,
YOURNAME

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/developer-advocacy/_index.md

<i class="fas fa-bullhorn fa-fw -text-purple"></i> Welcome to the Developer Advocacy Handbook

<i class="fa fa-map-marker" aria-hidden="true"></i> Mission

To support, grow, and engage the wider GitLab community through collaboration, content, and conversations.

<i class="fas fa-map-marked-alt"></i> Strategy

Developer relations and developer advocacy is an evolving, complex field.

Our team focuses on areas aligning with the company's areas of interest including:

- DevSecOps: We want our work to speak to not only developers but all team members involved in the DevSecOps lifecycle to deliver working code to production: Product Managers, software engineers, system and DB administrators, designers, test engineers, security engineers, operations engineers, platform engineers, SREs, development managers and executives, etc.
- Enterprise: Developers and DevSecOps professionals in the enterprise have special constraints and needs. Often these are glossed over with easy "throw out your architecture and use this new shiny thing" - we won't do that, we'll acknowledge real-world challenges, legacy code, and enterprise constraints and help people solve those problems as well. When applicable, we switch roles into consulting and support.

KPIs

The FY25 Marketing Strategy (internal only) shows a Customer Journey with five stages: Awareness, Consideration, Conversion, Expansion, and Evangelism.

While our team can influence people at each stage, our focus is on Awareness, Consideration, and Evangelism. The KPIs we use to measure our impact on these stages are:

- views from content published across owned and earned channels
- developers engaged through webinars, workshops, and industry events
- Developer Relations influenced pipeline (pipeline influenced by campaigns that are leveraging DevRel's content) and
- active community members

We recognize these KPIs don't capture the impact of the diverse range of work that our team does but understand that tradeoffs can be necessary to effectively communicate our impact within GitLab.

What fits in our strategy

When we are reviewing opportunities or requests for support, we must be able to answer yes to each of these questions to move forward with the work:

1. Will this work support, grow, and/or engage GitLab customers and community members?
1. Is there a measurable impact against one of our team's KPIs? Because of GitLab's global optimization subvalue, we'll also consider requests that influence a company KPI or contribute to progress on an OKR.

1. Has an issue been created to define the work and assign a DRI?

If the answer to any of the above questions is "no", we ask the requestor to take one of the following actions:

1. Make adjustments so we can take on the work.
1. Find another team that is better suited to deliver the work.
1. Come to an agreement that the work should not be done.

<i class="fa fa-users" aria-hidden="true"></i> Team members and focus areas

We are members of the Developer Relations team.

Team member	Focus areas	Languages	Projects	Technologies	Resources
-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
Cesar Saavedra 	Staff Developer Advocate	DevSecOps with a focus on CD, GitOps, Kubernetes, GitLab Flow, Feature flags, GitLab Duo	English, Spanish	GitLab demos on YouTube, Analyst relations demos, Competitive Research, CD Overview, Feature Flags, GitLab Flow	Kubernetes, GitOps, CI/CD, Java, AI
Daniel Helfand 	Developer Advocate	DevSecOps	English	CI/CD, Kubernetes, Go	
Fatima Sarah Khalid 	Developer Advocate	Community Engagement, DevSecOps	English	LinkedIn Live, Community Engagement	CI/CD, C++, PHP, JavaScript
Fernando Diaz 	Staff Developer Advocate	DevSecOps with a focus on Security and Compliance	English, Spanish	GitLab demos on YouTube, Analyst relations demos, event support, Security and Governance tutorials	Security, Kubernetes, CI/CD, Python
Itzik Gan-Baruch 	Staff Developer Advocate	DevSecOps with a focus on CI/CD, Remote Development/IDEs and Value Stream Management	English, Hebrew	Product tours, Click-through demos, CI/CD components	Remote Development, CI/CD, Value Stream Management
John Coghlan 	Director, Developer Advocacy	Strategy and Planning in Developer Advocacy	English		Website
Michael Friedrich 	Staff Developer Advocate	DevSecOps with a focus on efficiency with AI	English, German, Austrian	GitLab Duo Adoption, CI/CD components	DevSecOps, AI, CI/CD, Python, Go, C/C++, Rust
William Arias 	Staff Developer Advocate	DevSecOps with a focus on AI/ML, Sec and Data	English, Spanish	Support Ticket Sentiment Analysis, Competitive Research, Analyst relations demos, End-to-end DevSecOps Platform	CI/CD, AI/ML, Kubernetes, Security, Python, C

<i class="fa fa-tasks" aria-hidden="true"></i> What we do

Our developer advocate team can be summarized by the "Three Cs":

1. Content creation: This is what many often think of when thinking of the traditional role of developer relations: writing blog posts, delivering technical talks, participating in podcasts or panels, and sharing ideas and thoughts on social media. Content creation also includes assets co-created with other GitLab teams, inside and outside of Marketing.
1. Customer and community engagement: Our team regularly engages with GitLab customers and the wider GitLab community when they have questions, concerns, and feedback. This happens during in-person and virtual events, webinars, and meetings and online via GitLab issues, the GitLab Forum, Hacker News, and other social media sites.
1. Consulting: Within GitLab, our team represents the voice of the community. When other teams

are working on changes or decisions that will impact customers and the community, we will educate them on our customers and community, advocate for their interests, and work to ensure that any potential impacts are clearly understood and addressed when communicating such changes. Our team also shares our knowledge of industry trends, emerging tools, social media strategy, and other skills to support our teammates in achieving their goals in alignment with GitLab's Cross-functional Optimization subvalue.

Content creation

We build out content to help educate developers around best practices related to DevOps, GitLab, remote work, and other topics where we have expertise. Content includes presentations, demos, workshops, blog posts, and media engagements. Content creation also includes assets co-created with other GitLab teams, inside and outside of Marketing.

Please read the Content handbook to learn more about the content workflow, library and distribution with UTM tracking.

Customer and Community Engagement

Our team regularly engages with GitLab customers and the wider GitLab community. The Developer Advocate team is the DRI for questions and strategy on the platforms below:

<!-- This partially duplicates <https://handbook.gitlab.com/handbook/marketing/developer-relations/workflows-tools/tool-stack-overview> - when making updates, ensure to keep it in sync. -->

Platform	Description	Workflows
Discourse	The GitLab Forum is a place to ask and respond to questions and share projects or snippets of code.	Forum Workflows
Reddit	The GitLab Subreddit r/gitlab is a place to ask questions and share interesting use cases of GitLab and related workshops and tools.	r/gitlab Workflows
Discord	A GitLab Community Discord is a place to connect with the community, join pair coding sessions and live streams, and discuss all things GitLab and contribution.	Community Discord Workflows
Common Room	We use Common Room to aggregate and review insights from our community engagement.	Common Room Workflows

Community Response

Given the Developer Advocate team's understanding of our community and broad knowledge of GitLab, we will engage in the response of situations that require intervention to address urgent and important concerns of our community members. We have a documented process for how we manage these situations.

Consulting

Developer Advocates serve as consultants and subject matter experts (SMEs), leveraging their expertise and experience to support teams and customers with product features, new SKUs, and other topics.

Please read the Consultancy handbook to learn more about consultancy requests, decision matrix, and examples with GitLab Duo / AI adoption.

Other activities

Event support

The Developer Advocate team plays a key role in supporting events. We work closely alongside Corporate Event Marketing to provide strategic content and assistance for both corporate and third-party sponsored events. This collaboration ensures the success and seamless execution of various gatherings. To learn more please refer to the Events page.

We also help team members prepare for speaking opportunities at local tech events and meetups. If you'd like help preparing for such an event, please reach out to us in the dev-advocacy-team Slack channel or create an issue using the Developer Advocate Request template.

Release Advocacy

Developer Advocates should always be prepared to promote our monthly release and engage in community response on release days given the historical performance of release posts on Hacker News.

Social media

We build our thought leadership and distribute our content on social media. See Developer Advocacy on Social Media to learn more about our strategies and become a GitLab advocate yourself.

Spokespersons

Developer Advocates are subject matter experts (SMEs) in their focus areas, and collaborate with the Corporate Communications team to provide media coverage in the form of interviews, podcasts, content by-lines, etc. Developer Advocates are GitLab spokespersons and are required to take relevant training as determined by the Corporate Communications team.

Projects

Our team maintains projects to provide GitLab use cases for content creation (demos, recordings, blog posts, workshops, talks, etc.), help showcase technical concepts and research to customers, and automate our team processes. We work in public by default, so that everyone can learn and contribute. See Developer Advocate Projects for a list of all of those projects.

<i class="fa fa-code-branch" aria-hidden="true"></i> How we work

Find us on Slack

GitLab team members can also reach us at any time on the dev-advocacy-team Slack channel where we share updates, ideas, and thoughts with each other and the wider team.

We use developer-advocacy-updates for content shares and other updates that don't warrant

generating noise in the larger channel. Many updates are automated using Zapier workflows

Team meetings

1. Dev Advocacy team meeting (bi-weekly) - Agenda: search for Developer Advocacy Bi-Weekly in GDrive.
1. Developer Relations all-hands (monthly) - Agenda: search for Developer Relations & Strategy | All Hands Agenda in GDrive.
1. Dev Advocacy Showcase (monthly) - Agenda: search for Developer Advocacy Showcase [monthly] in GDrive.

Reporting

We organize our work through documented team workflows, ensuring transparency and efficiency. Most of our results reporting is automated through triage bots and metrics collection.

Additional reporting is provided in the weekly Developer Relations report, search for Developer Relations - End of Week updates in GDrive.

<i class="fa fa-calendar" aria-hidden="true"></i> Calendar

The Developer Advocate calendar provides insights into speaking engagements, important events, CFP timelines, and other dates. Learn more in our CFP handbook.

<iframe src="https://calendar.google.com/calendar/embed?src=c7930fcb0c9e4783bdd3d23858ae9af4306f28d976a40c833f50710c7cb86ba82%40group.calendar.google.com&ctz=UTC" style="border: 0" width="800" height="600" frameborder="0" scrolling="no"></iframe>

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/developer-advocacy/calendar.md

<i class="fa fa-calendar" aria-hidden="true"></i> Team Calendar

The Developer Advocacy Team calendar contains team member speaking engagements, important conferences, CFP timelines, and other important dates.

<iframe src="https://calendar.google.com/calendar/embed?src=c7930fcb0c9e4783bdd3d23858ae9af4306f28d976a40c833f50710c7cb86ba82%40group.calendar.google.com&ctz=UTC" style="border: 0" width="800" height="600" frameborder="0" scrolling="no"></iframe>

Developer Advocates should add new speaking engagements to this calendar as they are scheduled. The Developer Advocate Program Manager will manage team-wide events such as industry conferences and their CFP timelines. If you need write access to this calendar, please contact a member of the Developer Relations team via Slack.

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/developer-advocacy/cfps.md

CFP Resources

Event call for paper submission forms differ: Some require 1000 character abstracts, others prefer shorter biographies, or require you to fill in the talk learning goals. The Developer Advocacy team uses Google docs for maintaining CFP abstracts, @dnsmichi also uses a doc for the biography and headshot URLs as SSOT.

- CFP template Google doc.
- Biography template Google doc

How we manage CFPs (Call for Proposals)

Our events list

Every year, developer advocacy prioritizes key events in our ecosystem for which we run the conference proposal (CFP) process. The event engagement with lightning talks, CFP submissions, etc. is organized in issues which are linked and summarized in a yearly strategy epic. You can also find a calendar view of our events below:

<iframe src="https://calendar.google.com/calendar/embed?src=c7930fcb0c9e4783bdd3d23858ae9af4306f28d976a40c833f50710c7cb86ba82%40group.calendar.google.com&ctz=UTC" style="border: 0" width="800" height="600" frameborder="0" scrolling="no"></iframe>

CFP Library

Past submissions for CFPs are stored in the CFP Library.

Requesting a Developer Advocate to submit a CFP

To request that a Developer Advocate submits a CFP to your event, please:

1. Open a new issue
1. Ensure you use the developer-advocate-request template, and fill out the External Request section.
1. Label the issue with the CFP label.

CFP Management

For every CFP process we are participating in, a CFP issue is created with details about the event, requirements for CFP submissions and any other relevant information that might be useful to potential speakers. The issue template contains guide on the necessary steps needed to ensure we keep track of all the submissions for each CFP.

Once a submission has been submitted, the author should add it to the CFP Library. This will allow us to repurpose CFPs efficiently.

Issue Workflow

All submissions, accepted talks, feedback and other result tracking happens in the CFP issue. The CFP workflow uses scoped labels to transition the issues through different stages. Please follow the CFP workflow handbook to apply required labels accordingly.

All issues with the CFP label appear on the dedicated CFP Issue board.

Tips for CFP submissions

Writing good conference proposals is both an art and a science. The science is the details of the technical content. The art is presenting it in a way that appeals to the audience - the conference committee.

Here are some steps to go through when writing a CFP:

1. Research the event: Read through the event website in detail, especially the talk proposal pages. As you go through, notice the key topics and reoccurring themes throughout the material.
2. Familiarize yourself with the suggested topics: If an event suggests themes or topics, your best bet will be to align your talk proposal with that.
3. Learn about the conference committee: The people are just as essential as the online materials. Look up the committee and see if you can find out their own passion-topics. You should also research folks who may be past speakers or are otherwise involved with the conference to help understand what topics or speakers they are really looking for.
4. Write out a placeholder title, thesis, and outline: Starting with a placeholder title will help overcome the blank page syndrome. From there, brainstorm on your thesis. What are you trying to teach? If you had one line to explain the SCQA (Situation, Complication, Question, Answer) of the story, what would it be. Then fill out an SCQA outline.
5. Ask for help: Have a friend or colleague who is familiar with the subject matter review your proposal. Rework, rinse, repeat and submit!

Helpful links

1. Lachie's 7 step guide to writing a winning tech conference CFP
2. Make me an offer I can't refuse · Writing an abstracts for a CFP

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/developer-advocacy/community-newsletter.md

Overview of the Community Newsletter

We run a monthly Community Newsletter to share developer-focused content, keep community members informed about upcoming events, and promote contributions within the community. The target audience for this newsletter is aspiring and existing GitLab contributors in our community. This newsletter will not be used to drive or generate leads.

Process

The Community Newsletter is scheduled to send on last Thursday of each month at 10 AM PT / 6 PM UTC.

Open an issue using the community-newsletter template for the upcoming draft at least two weeks before the due date.

label DA-Status::ToDo: the newsletter is put together in an issue with submissions from the community and GitLab team members.

Send a slack reminder for the content deadline. Content is due the week before the planned send date to allow time for building the draft, design, and reviews.

Collaborate with the Social Marketing team on copy for sharing and promoting the newsletter issue.

label DA-Status::Doing: the newsletter is ready to be compiled in Marketo. Marketo is an email marketing tool used amongst other teams at GitLab to build and send newsletters.

label DA-Status::Done: After the newsletter has been sent, we leave the issue open for a week to collect feedback.

Capture the newsletter performance data in the issue, address any feedback for future iterations, and then close the issue.

Format

Introduction: a welcome message from the curators sharing projects they are working on, upcoming events, and a summary of the issue.

Featured Events: a feature on upcoming meetups or highlights from a recent community event.

GitLab Release Highlights

Resources: technical content from the GitLab Blog and other newsletters or resources.

Upcoming opportunities (e.g CFPs, projects)

Community Spotlight: a spotlight on our Community Programs or GitLab Heroes

Community Shoutout: sharing a tweet, video, or fun clip from the community.

Submissions

We would love to hear from you! To submit to the newsletter, please search for an active Newsletter Issue with the label Da-Type-Content::newsletter and share your submission in a comment.

Archive

The newsletter was started in 2022 and has been on two different closed platforms (Mailjet, Marketo) since. As a result, we don't have archives available for all of them.

FY23 Newsletter Epic.

All other past newsletter issues can be found using the label Da-Type-Content::newsletter and searching for closed issues.

1. 2022-06-27 - Issue 1.
1. 2022-08-08 - Issue 2 (hackathon announcement only).
1. 2022-09-19 - Issue 3 (content available on the issue).
1. 2022-09-23 - Issue 4.
1. 2022-10-04 - Issue 5
1. 2022-10-13 - Issue 6 (content available on the issue).
1. 2022-10-25 - Issue 7 (content available on the issue).
1. 2022-08-08 - Issue 8 (hackathon announcement only).
1. 2022-12-02 - Issue 9 (content available on the issue).

1. 2022-12-28 - Issue 10 (content available on the issue).
1. 2023-02-16 - Issue 11.
1. 2023-03-31 - Issue 12.
1. 2023-05-01 - Issue 13 - 536 subscribers, 41.99% open rate, 21.86% click rate.
1. 2023-06-02 - Issue 14 - 541 subscribers, 39.48% open rate, 21.61% click rate.
1. 2023-06-19 - Issue 15 - 548 subscribers, 37.11% open rate, 21.05% click rate.
1. 2023-08-03 - Issue 16 - 624 subscribers, 38.54% open rate, 18.06% click rate.
1. 2023-08-31 - Issue 17 - 652 subscribers, 36.2% open rate, 21.92% click rate.
1. 2023-11-23 - Issue 18 (not sent due to platform migration).
1. 2023-12-14 - Issue 19 (not sent due to platform migration).
1. 2024-01-25 - Issue 20 - 670 subscribers, 262 opens, 28 clicks.
1. 2024-03-29 - Issue 21 - 845 subscribers, 346 opens, 35 clicks.
1. 2024-05-31 - Issue 22 - 848 subscribers, 308 opens, 27 clicks.

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/developer-advocacy/community-response.md

How to engage developer advocates in community response

Given the developer advocacy team's familiarity with our community and broad knowledge of GitLab, we regularly engage in managing situations that require GitLab to address urgent and important concerns of our community members.

Our team uses the Community response board to organize tasks.

Notification

Upcoming announcement: To notify the developer advocacy team of an upcoming announcement, product change, or other news event that may elicit a response from our community, the DRI should comment to @johncoghlán in a relevant issue or notify the developer advocacy team in the dev-advocacy-team Slack channel. Please also apply the ~Community Interest and ~Community response labels to any relevant issues or epics related to this announcement.

In-progress situation: To notify the developer advocacy team of an urgent situation that is in-progress, please tag the @dev-advocates User Group in a Slack message in a Slack thread or channel where the situation is being discussed or the dev-advocacy-team Slack channel.

Please give the developer advocacy team as much notice as possible so we can help influence the messaging of the announcement, prepare responses for the community, and schedule coverage. See Scheduling below for more details.

Please add the Community response label to related issues, epics and MRs. Our team owns the label for the gitlab-com and gitlab-org groups. You can use this quick action: /label ~"dev-evangelism" ~"Community response" to apply the labels.

Preparation

In alignment with GitLab's efficiency value, the developer advocates will work with the Directly Responsible Individuals (DRIs) for the community response situation to help the DRI and other experts directly address the community feedback and questions.

When possible, the developer advocacy team will typically collaborate with the DRIs on a list of expected questions/concerns from the community and draft responses. When available, we also

include materials prepared for media responses, customer responses, or other materials related to the situation in our response preparation.

For high-priority announcements and news, we will conduct a practice exercise alongside the DRIs to test our preparation.

In many cases, we will want to direct the community to share their feedback in the GitLab Forum. By preparing a post that we can link to from a blog post, announcement, or community response will streamline how we gather feedback and manage responses. This post should be created by a Forum admin in advance as a private post which is published at the time of the announcement.

Note: when a forum post is used for feedback, consider turning off comments on the blog to encourage discussion on the forum.

Community Response plan

When possible, please create an issue using the Community Response Plan template and add details to each section per the instructions in the template.

This issue can be shared with stakeholders to gather more information from them and get sign off, as needed.

Forum Topic Preparation

Define a forum DRI from the administrators and moderators listed in the forum about page.

As response requestor, provide these details:

Forum topic title. Can be the blog post title, or a neutral placeholder when urgent. The Discourse forum renders the topic as URL slug automatically.

Final blog post URL. Does not need to exist yet.

The forum DRI navigates to + New topic and selects Internal as category. This is a private category accessible by team members.

Set the topic title and link the blog post URL which will later render a preview.

Create the forum topic, and send the URL to the response requestor.

Share the URL to the Forum Community Response Workflow handbook, providing instructions how to review and edit the topic on the forum.

Coordinate blog post publishing with forum topic publishing. This has a circular dependency on each other, and needs to be done in the same minutes.

The forum DRI edits the topic, changes the category to Community and saves the edit.

If the topic was prepared in advance of the announcement, the forum DRI updates the timestamp to match the date of publish.

If the topic has been edited and has multiple revisions, the forum DRI should Hide Revisions for each revision to avoid any confusion.

This makes the topic URL publicly accessible. Verify this in a new incognito browser (cmd+shift+n in Chrome on macOS).

Share the URL with the response requestor in Slack and/or issues.

Tip: If the blog post URL is not ready yet, create an empty forum topic, and add the blog URL in the publishing step. Discourse requires text in the post, use TODO: Add blog post URL and description.

Scheduling

If a response is expected to require monitoring and responses outside of our normal working hours (typically Monday - Friday, 900 UTC - 2200 UTC), please inform our team with as much notice as possible so we can schedule coverage accordingly.

Developer Advocacy team members who cover situations outside of their normal working hours are strongly encouraged to offset the extra time by scheduling time off in the days/weeks before or after the situation.

Scheduling should be coordinated with the DRI and tracked in a spreadsheet. Collaboration with the social media team and other teams may be required depending on the amount of coverage required.

Developer Advocates should always be prepared to respond to the release post on release day given the historical performance of release posts on Hacker News.

Monitoring

Our team will typically monitor the GitLab Forum, Hacker News, Reddit, and other online forums.

We will flag any content that we identify on social media in the appropriate channels, as needed.

The goal of monitoring these forums is to identify comments that require a response from GitLab and to respond directly or share those comments with the appropriate team member to respond.

Monitoring automation

We should strive to automate manual tasks for efficiency and to avoid unnecessary stress to individuals in the response team. In many cases, we use Zapier integrations to post mentions of GitLab in a Slack channel.

While we strive for consistency in the process of monitoring the individual community response channels, in some cases it might not be possible due to the nature of the platform (e.g. lack of an API). In cases where automation is not possible, we distribute monitoring tasks amongst that team.

This is a set of general recommendations for automating the monitoring processes on some of the channels the team will be listening to:

Hacker News:

New posts and comments containing the keyword "GitLab" are shared in the hn-mentions Slack channel.

Posts that reach the front page and contain the keyword "GitLab" are shared in the dev-advocacy-team Slack channel with additional tags for @dev-advocates and @sytses

Note: for both of these automations many posts and comments are captured that do not require a response. For example, posts that link to an open source project hosted on GitLab.

GitLab Forum:

Set up a Zap that posts on the relevant Slack channel created for internal response coordination. The trigger will be any new post created on the monitored thread in the forum. Depending on the topic's activity, this might mean quite a lot of unfiltered traffic. In this case, the Zap updates could be temporarily turned off at the discretion of the DRI assigned to monitor, and only manually posts that require a response.

Optionally, everyone in the response team can subscribe to the specific forum thread to

distribute the task of monitoring.

Blog Posts:

When there is a forum post linked to from the blog post announcing a change, it is recommended that comments will be disabled to encourage engagement on the forum post and for more efficient monitoring. Check the blog handbook to disable comments.

If comments are enabled, new comments will be posted in the mentions-of-gitlab Slack channel. Please join that channel for more efficient monitoring.

Response

When possible and appropriate, our team will engage experts to respond to the community. This direct feedback from the DRIs is appreciated by members of the wider GitLab community. It also allows the DRIs and experts to better understand community sentiment and get direct feedback from our community. To identify the DRIs for a specific feature, follow one of the these steps:

1. Search Google for the docs page that corresponds to the feature in question. For example, CI/CD.
1. Scroll to the bottom of the docs page for the feature
1. At the bottom of the page, click the "View page source" link
1. After the file opens in your browser, review the top of the file to see the stage/group that owns the feature
1. Use the browser search (keyboard shortcut cmd + f on macOS) to search for that feature, group, or stage on the Product sections, stages, groups, and categories page or the features by group page.

Contact the PM or other appropriate DRI in a public Slack channel whenever possible to raise the visibility of the question allowing others to engage should the DRI be unavailable.

Review these additional steps:

If necessary, the Developer Advocates will provide responses to community questions and concerns on the GitLab Forum, Hacker News, and other forums.

If a post about GitLab reaches the front page of Hacker News, we may use a Zoom room and Google Doc to collaborate on responses in synchronously. We will link to the Zoom room and Google Doc in the Slack thread or channel where the situation is being discussed or the dev-advocacy-team Slack channel.

The developer advocacy team will rarely engage in responding on Twitter and other social media channels during these announcements and breaking news situations. Twitter, Facebook, and LinkedIn are primarily owned by the Social Media team in these situations.

For situations where messaging is sensitive, we will rely on approved messaging from the Corporate Communications team to create our responses.

Rapid Action Responses

When there is an ongoing discussion with many threads and requiring multiple answers, proceed with bias for action to address them.

If the discussion is about a bug or security concern, analyze and understand the topic before taking action.

Make sure to explicitly address the concerns

Include answers for the underlying questions or speculations
Update issue descriptions from feedback, if they remain unclear or discussion points.
Copy the context of linked URLs into replies. Not everyone clicks the URLs and may miss the context.
Ask for feedback and contributions on how to improve the functionality or code quality.
Ensure all responses are SAFE and adhere to GitLab's team member social media policy before sending.

Example analysis for the file extensions not being allowed in usernames thread on HackerNews:

text

This bug affects the user profile page, when you call it like <https://gitlab.com/dnsmichi.html> it will not render the page correctly.

The attempt to fix was to disallow reserved file type extensions, but the error message was wrong.

In addition, there was speculation on security: does GitLab filtering this indicate that the protection against injection attacks is brittle? which needed additional clarification in this comment.

With added clarity, we can involve more experts and stakeholders to join the discussion.

When the topic is explicitly about GitLab and on the Hacker News front page for hours, we need to monitor and revisit it frequently.

Feedback

Retrospectives should be held following all major community response situations to achieve the following:

- Assess the quality of our message and preparation

- Assess the level of staffing for the situation, including how much time was invested in covering the event

- Identify things we did or could have done to be better prepared which we can apply to future response situations

- Update this handbook page and other materials based on what we learned

Our team is happy to provide sentiment assessments from our monitoring as part of the reporting or retrospective process for any announcements or in-progress situations which we are asked to support. Please tag us in the appropriate issue or document with a clear ask to request feedback.

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/developer-advocacy/consultancy.md

Teams and divisions can request consultancy in areas where Developer Advocates are Subject Matter Experts (SME), or can help with their experience or connection network.

Organization

Consultancy requests are labelled using the DA-Consulting:: scoped labels, with the DA-Type::Consulting label as pre-filtered list.

Request developer advocate consultancy

> Important: Verify that the request requires help from the Developer Advocacy team before requesting consultancy. In most cases, the Solution and Demo Architects teams are the first to ask for help.

Developer Advocates and requestors can use the consultancy-request issue template.

Decision matrix

1. ARR (and influenced ARR for SKUs)

1. Aligned with company direction and Developer Relations strategy (for example, a specific Vertical in the quarter).

1. Expertise and resources. If developer advocates cannot deliver on a specific programming language/framework, or do not have the resources to prepare for consultancy, we will deny the request and suggest alternative DRIs on the SA/CSM/Engineering teams.

Consultancy areas

There is a wide variety of areas and topics that can be requested. It is important for Developer Advocates that requests align with their expertise and resources, and are not too broad, or without success exit criteria. All consultancy requests should be turned into opportunities to repurpose the learnings or created resources into more content.

Generally, all product areas, features and technology can be requested. The sections below document a few recent examples of requests and their results.

GitLab Duo / AI Adoption

Goal: Help customers adopt GitLab Duo and AI-powered DevSecOps workflows.

Developer Advocates are encouraged to help with

- (Live) programming workshops, when fluent and confident in the requested language together with GitLab Duo.
- Code challenges for customer engineering teams to test GitLab Duo.
- GitLab UI and IDE setup and troubleshooting.
- Latest product updates and improvements.
- Best practice resources, demos, product tours, and use cases (see content library)
- Support field teams in Slack (ai-field-strategy, ai-sme-request, ai-field-technical).

Collaboration for customer workshops is important. Solution Architects lead the Proof of Value (PoV) workshops for GitLab Duo and AI. They get help building the workshop outline from the SA Demo Architects and Customer Success Management team. Developer Advocates are encouraged to help with programming workshops, IDE setup and troubleshooting, and generally sharing best practices as a developer with customer's (engineering) teams.

Customer feedback can inspire bug reports, feature proposals, documentation updates, blog tutorials, demo stories and much more. Make sure to always listen and take notes during customer engagements.

Customer adoption engagement examples are available in the FY25Q2 OKR KR, the GitLab Duo (AI) Adoption FY25 (DevRel) epic and this pre-filtered issue list.

Results:

- Customer workshops for GitLab Duo (full maintained list in the content handbook)
 - GitLab Duo Use Case - Python workshop 2024-07-10
 - Build your own adventure with GitLab Duo - C++ observability tool with embedded hardware sensors
- Blog: Best practice tutorials for customers and field teams (AI/ML blog category/)
- Documentation
 - Author and maintain the GitLab Duo Use Case documentation and linked resources:
 - GitLab Duo Prompts library
 - GitLab Duo Challenges
 - Improve GitLab Duo Onboarding
- Continued GitLab Duo Coffee Chats helping specific customer workflows (refactoring, code generation prompts, etc.).
- Product/Engineering: Feature proposals and bug reports (FY25 epic (internal)).
 - Add /fix slash command for Duo Chat (issue).

SME DRI: @dnsmichi

MLOps Adoption

Goal: Enable data scientists and MLOps engineers to adopt DevSecOps practices and enjoy the benefits of automation, repeatable workflows, standardization, and automatic provisioning of infrastructure.

Recent customer workshop examples are available in this pre-filtered issue list (internal).

SME DRI: @waarias

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/developer-advocacy/content.md

The Developer Advocacy team creates content that can be used for campaigns, field enablement, product launch support, use case adoption, customer demos, and general learning and onboarding. All contents and activities the team participates in are tracked in issues following team workflows.

Request content

Note: If you need an updated or newly created content asset, please follow the content request workflow.

Content Library

You can search for relevant content on this handbook page, and contact the team in the linked content epics or in the dev-advocacy-team Slack channel.

The following sections provide an overview of all content assets, and links to find them.

Highspot

The team's content is distributed in the content platforms below, and in Highspot in topic and type-specific spots, for example, GitLab Duo (AI) and Customer Outreach.

Blog posts

This section provides examples from the many blog posts authored by the Developer Advocacy team. Click on the author names for a full list of blog posts.

- Cesar Saavedra
 - Modernizing a simple C++ application to Java with GitLab Duo
 - 5 videos and interactive tours to learn GitLab Duo fast
 - Combine GitLab Flow and GitLab Duo for a workflow powerhouse
 - How to use feature flags to lower risk in deployments
- Daniel Helfand
 - How to stream logs through the GitLab Dashboard for Kubernetes
- Fatima Sarah Khalid
 - Develop C++ unit testing with Catch2, JUnit, and GitLab CI
 - Explore the Dragon Realm: Build a C++ adventure game with a little help from AI
 - How to choose the right static site generator
- Fernando Diaz
 - Quick vulnerability remediation with GitLab Advanced SAST + Duo AI
 - Get to know the security and governance updates in GitLab 17, 17.1
 - Migration guide: GitHub Advanced Security to GitLab Ultimate
 - How to integrate custom security scanners into GitLab
- John Coghlan
 - Developer Relations at GitLab: What we've learned since our start
 - Building GitLab with GitLab: How GitLab.com inspired Dedicated
- Itzik Gan Baruch
 - Quickly resolve broken CI/CD pipelines with AI
 - FAQ: GitLab CI/CD Catalog
 - Refactoring a CI/CD template to a CI/CD component
 - Jenkins to GitLab: The ultimate guide to modernizing your CI/CD environment
- Michael Friedrich
 - Refactor code into modern languages with AI-powered GitLab Duo
 - Top tips for efficient AI-powered Code Suggestions with GitLab Duo
 - 10 best practices for using AI-powered GitLab Duo Chat
- William Arias
 - Building GitLab with GitLab: Why there is no MLOps without DevSecOps
 - Modern software development problems require modern AI-powered DevSecOps
 - How Comet can streamline machine learning on The GitLab DevOps Platform

Click-through Demos

Click-through demos are product simulation demonstrations that can be used for self-guided training. They are invaluable for delivering demos to customers in areas with limited internet connectivity or complex environments, where preparation is necessary to showcase the flow. Toggle off the click boxes and speaker notes using fn+F2 to experience the real look and feel of the product.

Title	Area	Last updated
Duo chat	GitLab Duo	2024-06-19
GitLab Duo (AI)	GitLab Duo	2023-07-23
Workspaces	Dev section, Create	2023-05-23
Feature Flags	CD	2023-06-23
CI Overview	CI	2023-10-23

Note: The demos can be run offline in the absence of internet connectivity. To do so, you can directly obtain the necessary HTML files from [here](#).

Product tours

Product tours are a self-guided journey emphasizing the 'What' of a feature, skipping the 'How-to' steps to directly showcase the value aspects.

Title	Area	Last updated	DRI
GitLab Premium and Ultimate with Duo	GitLab Duo	2025-05-18	@iganbaruch
GitLab Duo with Amazon Q	GitLab Duo	2025-04-23	@iganbaruch
GitLab Duo Workflow	GitLab Duo	2025-03-18	@iganbaruch
GitLab Duo Self-Hosted	GitLab Duo	2025-02-13	@iganbaruch
Compliance Frameworks	DevSecOps Platform	2025-01-27	@iganbaruch
Compliance Frameworks - Japanese	DevSecOps Platform	2025-05-27	@iganbaruch
Idea to MR	Duo with Amazon Q	2024-12-03	@iganbaruch
Java modernization	Duo with Amazon Q	2024-12-03	@iganbaruch
Advanced SAST	DevSecOps Platform	2024-09-22	@iganbaruch
AI Impact analytics	GitLab Duo	2024-08-13	@iganbaruch
Duo Enterprise	GitLab Duo	2024-07-28	@iganbaruch
Value Stream Management	DevSecOps Platform	2024-06-25	@iganbaruch
Interactive infographic	DevSecOps Platform	2024-03-24	@iganbaruch
Resolving vulnerabilities with GitLab Duo (AI)	GitLab Duo	2024-02-24	@iganbaruch
CI/CD Catalog	CI/CD	2024-01-24	@iganbaruch
Integrating security to the pipeline	DevSecOps	2024-01-24	@iganbaruch
Code Suggestions	GitLab Duo	2024-01-24	@iganbaruch

Internal Product tours

While the product tours provide guided walkthroughs with navigation dialogs and explanations at each step and can serve as self-guided tours for customers, the internal product tours are designed to help GitLab team members demo features to customers and prospects. These tours omit the explanation dialogs, creating a seamless live demo experience. Refer to the navigation

guides to learn how to navigate through the flows.

Title	Area	Last updated	DRI
-----	-----	-----	-----
Compliance Frameworks	DevSecOps Platform	2025-02-20	@iganbaruch
Idea to MR	Duo with Amazon Q	2025-01-05	@iganbaruch
Java modernization	Duo with Amazon Q	2025-01-05	@iganbaruch
Advanced SAST	DevSecOps Platform	2024-09-24	@iganbaruch
AI Impact analytics	GitLab Duo	2024-10-30	@iganbaruch
Duo Enterprise	GitLab Duo	2024-10-28	@iganbaruch

Please search for the "[product name] tour - navigation guide" (ex: Advanced SAST tour - navigation guide) in Google Drive to find the step by step instructions to navigate through these tours.

Videos

YouTube playlists

GitLab YouTube channel:

- GitLab Demos
- GitLab Snapshots
- GitLab Snapshots - español
- GitLab Snapshots - português
- GitLab Duo Snapshots

GitLab Unfiltered YouTube channel:

- Developer Advocacy with talk recordings, workshops and community engagements.
- GitLab Duo Coffee Chat, learning sessions with GitLab Duo and AI.
- DevOps with GitLab Duo, learning sessions with GitLab Duo, DevOps and AI.

Vimeo folder

- Developer Relations (internal)

Workshops

The Developer Advocacy team maintains workshops in different product and focus areas. A workshop can be of different types: Hands-on with audience participating live in the exercises (training course), or showcase live demo/programming sessions where the audience engages with questions. Workshops should be created in collaboration with the Solution Architect and Customer Success teams, and aligned with business goals.

> Note: Specific customer focussed workshops can be requested following the customer consultancy handbook.

Title	Area	Type	Focus	DRI	Resources
-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----

| GitLab Duo best practices - Build a Python shop app | GitLab Duo | Showcase, audience watching/engaging, Sales Proof-of-value workshops (60min + async content) | Python, shop app | @dnsmichi | 2024-05-07 livestream with Eddie Jaoude, 2024-07-01, 2024-08-21 Python app, 2024-10-01 best practices |
| Build your own adventure with GitLab Duo - C++ observability tool and hardware sensors | GitLab Duo | Showcase, audience watching/engaging, Sales Proof-of-value workshops (60min + async content) | C++, observability, embedded, sensors, metrics | @dnsmichi | 2024-12-05 Build your own adventure - C++ |

Maintained documentation

Developer advocates authored and maintain the following documentation pages, with practical and technical examples aiding adoption and efficiency use cases.

Title	Area	Created	DRI
GitLab Duo use cases	Duo/AI	2024-03	@dnsmichi
CI/CD component examples	CI/CD	2024-02	@dnsmichi
Automate storage management	Utilization, API	2023-08	@dnsmichi
Pipeline efficiency	CI/CD	2020-09	@dnsmichi

Maintained talks

These golden talk slide decks provide storytelling for lightning talks at events, speaking engagements, customer workshops, etc. You can use the slide decks for your own talks, workshops, etc. or repurpose specific slides into new stories.

These talks are maintained:

Title	Area	Focus	Resources	Last updated	DRI
Efficient DevSecOps workflows with a little help from AI	AI, GitLab Duo	Product use cases with Duo	DACH Roadshow FY25 slides: public, internal	2024-11-14	@dnsmichi
Efficient DevSecOps workflows with a little help from AI	AI, GitLab Duo	Generic use cases talk for public events (no product pitches)	IT-Tage 2024 slides: public, internal, GitLab project	2024-12-09	@dnsmichi
Efficient DevSecOps workflows with reusable CI/CD components	CI/CD	Practical migration help	Chemnitz Linux Days slides: public, internal, and recording	2025-03-22	@dnsmichi

Projects

Source code, demo projects, workshops, tutorials, research, etc. are documented in the Projects handbook. This includes use cases for GitLab Duo (AI), CI/CD components, DevSecOps and Security, Workspaces, GitLab API, etc.

Content Creation

Videos

For your screen recording:

1. We recommend Quicktime or OBS.
1. Set window size to an aspect ratio of 16x9. Common resolution is 1920x1080 (16:9 aspect ratio) or 2880x1750 for screen recordings.
1. If recording for social, consider square (1:1) for multi-platform compatibility or vertical (9:16).
1. If you're connected to a 4K monitor, it may be easier to capture from your laptop.
1. Be overly generous with zoom in your IDE so that our viewers can clearly see what is happening on screen. Zoom (cmd + +) once or twice more than you think you need to.
1. You can simplify view by hiding unnecessary icons that are nested in top and bottom bars or using Zen mode, cmd+k+z
1. Additional guidance can be found in the internal handbook: dev environments

Recording with OBS

In many cases, OBS will allow greater control and flexibility for screen recordings.

Here are some tips to keep in mind:

- Scene - a scene is a collection of sources that you will record simultaneously.
- Sources - sources can be audio, screen recordings, webcams, etc.
 - To add a source, click the + icon. These are the three most common sources you will use:
 - macOS Screen Capture: screen recordings
 - Audio Input Capture: optional, when direct voice recording is needed
 - Video Capture Input: optional with speaker/webcam in the recording
 - To record your Macbook screen, use macOS Screen Capture, give the source a name, and right-click to edit the Source properties.
 - Properties - these are elements of the Source you can modify. You can choose between different screens (laptop vs monitor) as well as whether to capture the whole screen, a window, or a specific application.
- Preferences - preferences control how your Scene gets recorded. We recommend the following preferences:
 - OBS > Preferences > Video
 - Base (Canvas) Resolution 1920x1080, Aspect ratio 16:9
 - Output (Scaled) Resolution 1920x1080, Aspect ratio 16:9
 - OBS > Preferences > Output > Dropdown: Advanced.
 - OBS > Preferences > Advanced: Enable "Recording > Automatically remux to mp4" (this is important for Adobe Premiere Pro which cannot import mkv containers)
- Search for obs-setup.mp4 for a video tutorial showing how to setup OBS

Product Tours

Guideline and tips for creating GitLab tours with Navattic

1. Keep it concise · Product tours should ideally have 5 to 12 steps, each focused on delivering clear value. Unlike tutorials, which tend to be instructional, product tours should be quick and engaging.
2. Provide context · Add links to blog posts and documentation in pop-up dialogs to provide additional resources without cluttering the main content.
3. Apply GitLab branding · In the theme settings, select "GitLab Branding [Navattic Team]" to ensure a consistent design.

4. Use the appropriate capture type · Navattic supports two types of screen captures:
 - Web captures (preferred) create an in-product experience.
 - Screenshots should be used for non-web-based applications (e.g., IDEs).
5. Set the correct resolution · When capturing in Chrome, set your browser to 1680x1050 (Full HD). You can use Window Resizer to adjust the resolution.
6. Include a call to action · The final step should feature a CTA, typically a Free Trial link.
7. Use Beacons to highlight elements · Apply the Highlight appearance setting to emphasize key elements.
8. Enable keyboard navigation · This features in the tour settings allows users to navigate the tour using arrow keys for a smoother experience.
9. Use Presenter Mode · This feature hides pop-ups when necessary, ensuring a cleaner visual presentation.
10. Set pop-ups appropriately:
 - Use Modals with a heavy backdrop for the first and last steps.
 - Use Tooltips for intermediate steps, enabling the Backdrop setting when appropriate.
11. In the Dialogs, please try using action-specific labels like "Commit," "Install," or "Submit" instead of "Next" to make users feel like they are actively engaging with the product.
12. Refer to available examples · Review existing product tours to understand the preferred format.
13. Before releasing any public facing product tour, request a review from the DA team.

Requesting Access to Navattic

If your team has special requirements for tours and you want to develop tours with Navattic yourself, we can help.

- We can offer a 3-month trial license to team members who request access and provide a valid business justification for using Navattic.
- If a user actively utilizes the tool, we may extend their access or consider purchase additional licenses as needed.
- If a user is not actively using the tool, their license may be reassigned to another team member.
- To request access, open an issue

For questions or assistance, reach out to us in our team channel: dev-advocacy-team.

Publishing Product Tours

Product tours are published in the following locations:

- DA Handbook
- Highspot
- Docs (follow the GitLab documentation style guide for demo links)

Additionally, select tours may be featured on the website.

Contribute to product tours

The Developer Advocacy team creates product tours to showcase key workflows and highlight new features, such as Advanced SAST, GitLab Duo, Duo with Amazon Q, and more. The team is committed

to building, reviewing, and publishing product tours to ensure a consistent and high-quality experience for our users and potential customers. You can also contribute by proposing additional tours and provide the content, script, and environment. Here is how you can collaborate with the Developer Advocacy team to create new product tours:

1. Use the product tour submission template to propose your idea.
1. Answer all the questions in the template. This ensures the Developer Advocacy team can evaluate your idea effectively.
1. The Developer Advocacy team will review the pitch and either a) greenlight the tour and suggest timeline for creation based on other priorities the team has, b) offer suggestions for improvements, or c) explain why the idea might not be a fit for the tour and offer other ideas for getting the message out.
1. Once a tour is approved, the author will use the product tour template (google doc) to draft the script. Link to the template exists in the product tour submission template.
1. Add a link to the template in a comment in the submission template issue.
1. The Developer Advocacy team will collaborate with the author on the script, use Navattic to create the tour, and publish it in the official targets when applicable (for example, website, docs, HighSpot, Developer Advocacy handbook).

Content Distribution

UTMs for URL tagging and tracking

The Developer Advocacy team works with the Developer Relations Team UTM Strategy, which is based on the larger Marketing UTM strategy. The `utmcontent` prefix for the Developer Evangelism team is `de`, this allows for easily filtering of the team's data in Sisense.

You can use the UTM Generator on the Community UTM Page to easily generate UTM Codes for your campaigns.

We use the following campaigns:

1. Blog posts (general) - All GitLab blog where we are not authors. Content tracking for social media.
1. Blog posts (authors) - GitLab blog posts where we are authors. Content tracking for social media.
1. Talk resources (general) - QR codes and short URLs for talk slides.
1. Community newsletter - community newsletter short URLs.
1. Demos (TMM, DE) - technical demos with standalone URLs.
1. Release Evangelism - Release evangelism activities.
1. Podcast resources - URLs shared with podcast hosts.
1. Contributed articles - external articles shared on social media.

Event and content specific tracking examples are KubeCon EU 2023.

Content Distribution Workflow

After content has been crafted and published, the next step is distribution. Here are some steps to assist in the process:

1. Use the UTM Generator to create UTM codes and short URLs for your content. Further insights about this can be found in the Developer Advocacy UTM Strategy.

For documentation and community:

1. Tutorial blog posts, demos, etc. that are helpful to everyone should be added to the GitLab documentation. Follow the contribution docs and create related topics headings if not existing. Raise an MR, use content short URLs, and ask the assigned technical writer to review. Example MR: Add tutorial blog posts to workspaces docs
1. Consider sharing your content on one of our community platforms like the GitLab Forum or the r/gitlab subreddit. If you're covering a topic that's broader than GitLab, you can also consider other subreddits or cross-posting your content on blogging sites like dev.to.

For social media:

1. Draft some copy for sharing your content on social media. See Content Sharing for tips and an overview of different platforms. Review the message tips for additional engagement ideas, e.g. emojis.
1. Suggest your content as a story on EveryoneSocial so other GitLab team members can also share it. Details on how to suggest content on EveryoneSocial.
1. After posting your content on social media, share a link in the social-media-action Slack channel to request promotion from the social media team.

For GitLab teams:

1. Content that can be useful to our Field Teams, should also be posted in Highspot.
1. Share an update in the dev-advocacy-team Slack channel using the following message template:

text
:results-tanuki: <Content type> published: <title>

Social short UTM URLs:

1. LinkedIn:
2. Twitter:
3. Mastodon:

Content epic: <URL>

Thanks/cc @teammembers

Example:

text
:results-tanuki: Blog published: Set up your infrastructure for on-demand, cloud-based development environments in GitLab

Social short UTM URLs:

1. LinkedIn: <https://go.gitlab.com/EHljRt>
2. Twitter: <https://go.gitlab.com/uz7OSE>
3. Mastodon: <https://go.gitlab.com/pFxdKa>

Content epic: <URL>

Thanks a lot @HelpfulCoworker for editing this long read :handshake: :purpleheart:

Product Adoption Initiatives

- FY25 GitLab Duo adoption - Developer Relations epic (internal).
- FY25 CI/CD adoption - Developer Relations epic (internal)

SECTION: marketing/developer-relations/developer-advocacy/hacker-news.md

Overview

Hacker News is an important social channel. Threads that mention GitLab's structure, values, product vision, or other sensitive blog posts, articles, etc. should be treated as important, while posts about GitLab that land on the front page of Hacker News should be treated as both important and urgent.

Hacker News posts are important because they can generate traffic for our website, backlinks to our content, and, most importantly, value feedback on our product and processes. As an example, a Hacker News post about this page from January 2022 generated valuable feedback for our team.

GitLab mentions on Hacker News are tracked on the hn-mentions Slack channel. Posts about GitLab that land on the front page of Hacker News generate a notification that is shared in dev-advocacy-team. More details in the automation documentation.

What performs well

In 2020, we ran multiple experiments to try to drive interest in new posts about GitLab. We learned that the key to a post reaching the front page was the content itself. Timing of when a post is shared can also help but is out of our control as we do not post our own content. Creating a coordinated response was not effective in driving interest in the posts without organic interest from the Hacker News community. The content is the key to success.

We conducted an audit to see what types of posts about GitLab landed on the front page of Hacker News. We learned that the following types of GitLab-related content generated the most interest on Hacker News:

- Major company news such as announcements about funding, acquisitions, or moving features to core
- Release posts
- Announcements from our open source program members including posts from Gnome, KDE, and WikiMedia and other open-source focused content

- Technical blog posts
- Remote-focused content including handbook pages and the Remote Work report

When considering what types of content to publish on social media, these are all good types of posts and pages to share on Twitter, LinkedIn, relevant Slack communities, and other social channels.

Release days

GitLab Release Posts frequently perform well on Hacker News. Given that we know the post will be released every month, we should always plan for these posts to warrant a community response. For release days, we follow these steps to organize our response:

1. Director, Developer Advocacy will send out a recurring calendar invite for release days with a link to this section of the handbook in the body of the invite as a reminder to Developer Advocacy team members.
1. If a notification that a release post has reached the Hacker News Front Page is posted to the dev-advocacy-team Slack channel by the "Hacker News Front Page" bot, a Developer Advocacy team member should quickly repost the message to the product and release-post channels to alert our Product Managers.
1. As questions / comments are added to the Hacker News post, Developer Advocates should quickly respond to address community feedback.
1. For questions / comments that the Developer Advocates are unable to address on their own, they should quickly activate to engage experts. The most efficient way to engage experts are to: notify product managers via @ mentions in the thread created in the product channel with a link to the comment which they should address. Note: Don't be shy about engaging experts as the community feedback is valuable to them as they work to improve GitLab.

More information on Release Posts, including the Release Post Managers schedule, is available in the handbook.

Responding on Hacker News

When new posts or comments about GitLab are added to Hacker News, team members can find alerts about these posts in the hn-mentions Slack channel. You are welcome to share these with other team members and members of the wider GitLab community who may want to engage in the discussion. Please join the dev-advocacy-team Slack channel for questions, response coordination for front page posts, guidance on responding, etc.

Developer Advocacy team members are encouraged to address comments and questions on new posts when appropriate.

Response workflow

1. When alerted by the "Hacker News Front Page Bot" that an article referencing GitLab is on the Front Page of Hacker News, the Developer Advocates should coordinate to ensure a DRI is assigned to the post to review, monitor the comments, and respond accordingly.
1. Posts that reach the front page should be shared in Slack channels relative to the topic of the post for greater visibility among team members who may wish to respond. For example, a remote work blog should be shared in the remote channel and a post related to trackers on our

marketing site should be shared in marketing. Whenever posts are shared outside of dev-advocacy-team, the Slack comment should be cross-linked in the alert thread in dev-advocacy-team for visibility and to create a single source of truth.

1. Developer Advocates should also review the hn-mentions Slack channel 1-2 times per day for mentions that require a response. If you are able to provide a quick response/resource, reply on news.ycombinator.com using your personal Hacker News account and indicate that you replied by leaving a :whitecheckmark: on the Slack comment. Note that the window to edit a comment is 2 hours, afterwards you cannot edit or delete a Hacker News comment.

1. If necessary, you may also wish to share comments with relevant experts who may be able to provide more detailed or insightful comment